How to Make Fried Rice

Introduction

Fried rice is a popular dish often prepared in restaurants, but it can also be made quickly and effectively at home using simple ingredients and basic kitchen tools. This instruction set includes equipment, ingredients, step-by-step instructions, troubleshooting tips, and variations.

These instructions are intended for beginners or home cooks who may not have prior experience making fried rice. The process requires basic cooking skills, such as chopping ingredients and using a stove, but also introduces techniques such as stir-frying and cooking ingredients in stages. The entire process takes approximately 20–30 minutes and should be completed in a standard kitchen environment.

Equipment

- Wok or large pan
- Metal Spatula
- Knife
- Cutting board
- 5 Small Bowls
- 1 Medium Bowl
- Grater
- Fork

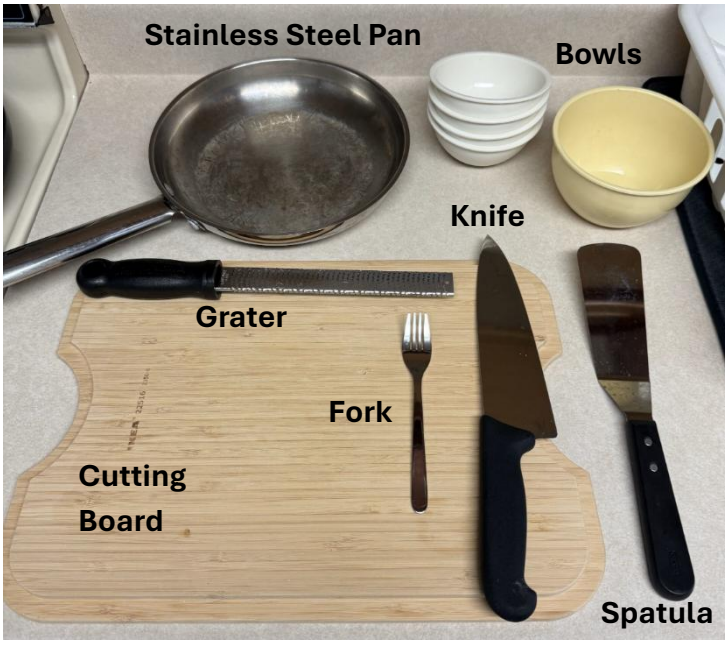

Figure 1: Required Equipment

Ingredients

- 2 cups day old, cooked jasmine rice (or any long grain rice)
- 1 Chicken breast
- 2 eggs
- 1/2 cup frozen peas and carrots
- 2 green onions
- 3 cloves garlic
- 1 inch fresh ginger (Peeled)
- 2 tablespoons light soy sauce
- 1–2 tablespoons avocado oil (or any other neutral tasting, high smoke point oil)
- 1 teaspoon toasted sesame oil
- Salt (to taste)
- MSG (to taste)
- White pepper (to taste)

Figure 2: Required Ingredients (excluding rice)

Safety and Cautions

- Use caution when working with hot oil and heated pans.
- Handle knives carefully when chopping ingredients.
- Constantly monitor pan to prevent food from burning.

Glossary

- **Chop:** Cut into small pieces.
- **Grate:** Shred into fine pieces.
- **To taste:** Adjust seasoning based on personal preference.
- **Aromatics:** Ingredients like garlic, ginger, and onions used for flavor.
- **Stir-fry:** Cooking quickly over high heat while stirring.

Instructions

1. Prepare the Ingredients

REQUIRED MATERIALS: Cutting Board, Knife, Grater, 3 Small Bowls, Fork

REQUIRED INGREDIENTS: Green Onions, Ginger, Garlic, Eggs, Chicken Breast

1) Set down the cutting board, making sure it is stable with no movement
    - If sliding occurs, place a slightly dampened towel under the board
2) Grate ginger into a bowl using grater
3) Grate garlic into same bowl as ginger
4) Obtain the knife and prepare to begin cutting ingredients
5) Chop the green onions, separating the green and white portions
6) Set white parts into bowl with garlic and ginger, these are the aromatics
7) Set green parts into a separate bowl
8) Dice the chicken breast into small, even sized cubes
9) Crack eggs into a new bowl
10) Whisk the eggs with a fork until smooth

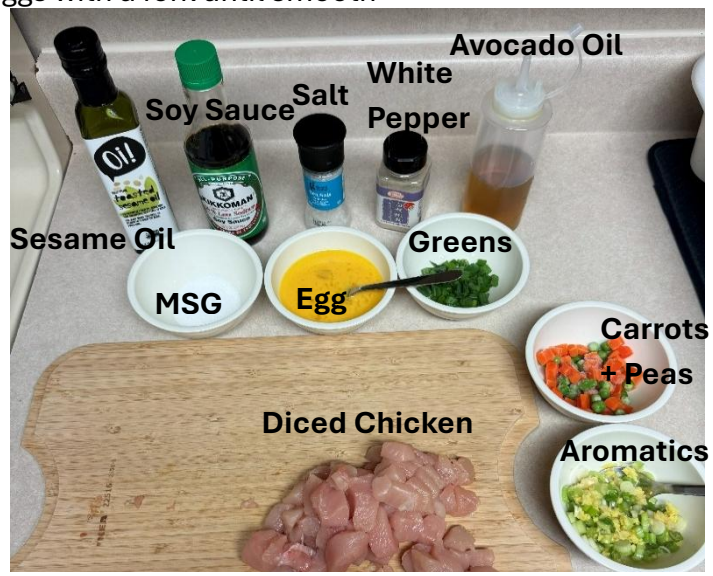

Figure 3: Prepped Ingredients (excluding rice)

2. Cook the Eggs + Chicken

REQUIRED MATERIALS: Wok/Pan, Spatula, Medium Sized Bowl

REQUIRED INGREDIENTS: Whisked Eggs, Avocado Oil, Diced Chicken

1) Heat pan over medium heat
2) Once heated add one tablespoon of oil, allow it to heat for about 2 minutes
3) Pour whisked eggs into pan (Figure 4)
4) Lightly season eggs with salt

Figure 4: Eggs when first poured into hot pan

5) Stir continuously with spatula until eggs are fully cooked
6) Remove eggs from pan and set into bowl (Figure 5)

Figure 5: fully cooked eggs removed into bowl

7) Add more oil to coat bottom of pan, if required
8) Add chicken to pan in a single layer, being sure not to overcrowd the pan
9) Allow chicken to cook without disturbing, until lightly browned (Figure 6)

Figure 6: lightly browned, fully cooked chicken

10) Toss chicken in pan with spatula until fully cooked through
11) Remove from pan and set into bowl with eggs

3. Stir-Fry Aromatics and Vegetables

REQUIRED MATERIALS: Wok/Pan, Spatula

REQUIRED INGREDIENTS: Aromatics, Avocado Oil, Carrots + Peas

1) In the same pan from previous step, add more oil to coat bottom if needed
2) Add aromatics mixture to the hot pan (Figure 7)

Figure 7: aromatics when added to pan

3) Stir with spatula for 30 seconds until fragrant
4) Add frozen carrot + peas
5) Stir-fry for 2-3 minutes until softened

4. Add and Fry the Rice

REQUIRED MATERIALS: Wok/Pan, Spatula

REQUIRED INGREDIENTS: Rice, Avocado Oil

1) Add rice to the pan in small handfuls, tossing to ensure coverage in oil (Figure 8)

Figure 8: handful of rice added to pan

2) Use spatula to break up any clumps in the rice
3) Add additional oil to pan, tossing to ensure grains are covered
4) Stir continuously until rice is fully heated and lightly browned (Figure 9)

Figure 9: rice should be lightly browned

5. Season and Combine

REQUIRED MATERIALS: Wok/Pan, Spatula

REQUIRED INGREDIENTS: Soy Sauce, White Pepper, MSG, Egg + Chicken Mixture, Sesame Oil

1) Add chicken and eggs back into the pan with the rice
2) Pour soy sauce onto edge of pan, to allow it to caramelize before mixing
3) Toss until soy sauce is evenly distributed throughout the rice
4) Add salt, MSG, and white pepper to taste
5) Add sesame oil
6) Toss rice until it is well combined (Figure 10)
7) Remove pan from heat

Figure 10: fully seasoned and completed fried rice

6. Serve

1) Scoop desired portion onto dish of choosing
2) Top with the greens of the onions
3) Optionally garnish with sesame seeds (Figure 11)

Figure 11: completed fried rice, garnished with onion greens and sesame seeds

Troubleshooting

- If the rice is too mushy, use day-old rice which has less moisture and provides a better texture
- If rice sticks to the pan, add a small amount of oil and ensure pan is properly heated
- If the rice lacks flavor, add additional soy sauce, salt, MSG, or white pepper to taste

Serving Suggestions

- Serve fried rice as a main dish or as a side dish
- Top with chili crisp for added heat and texture
- Pair with additional proteins or veggies for a more complete meal

Supplementary Information

Using day-old rice is recommended because freshly cooked rice contains excess moisture, which can lead to a mushy texture when stir-fried. Allowing rice to cool and dry improves the final texture of the dish.

This recipe can be customized by changing the protein. For example, chicken can be replaced with shrimp, beef, tofu, or omitted entirely for a vegetarian version.

Fried rice also varies across different cultures. While the overall cooking process remains the same, specific ingredients can be adjusted to create different regional styles:

- **Indonesian Fried Rice (Nasi Goreng):** Replace light soy sauce with sweet soy sauce (kecap manis). Add chili paste or sambal for heat. Optionally include fried shallots for garnish.
- **Chinese Fried Rice:** Use light soy sauce as the primary seasoning. Keep ingredients simple with eggs, green onions, and vegetables. Avoid strong sauces to maintain a balanced flavor.
- **Thai Fried Rice:** Replace part of the soy sauce with fish sauce. Add a squeeze of lime juice at the end and include fresh herbs such as cilantro. Chili can also be added for heat.
- **Japanese Fried Rice (Chahan):** Use less soy sauce and focus on lighter seasoning. Add ingredients such as diced vegetables or ham. The texture should be less oily and more subtle in flavor.

Conclusion

By following these steps, you can successfully prepare authentic fried rice using proper technique and timing. With continued practice, you can adjust ingredients, experiment with different proteins, and explore regional variations to suit your preferences. This method provides a reliable foundation for making fried rice at home with consistent results.